



Bupa Health Services – Partnered Health

MN-50028

Phase 1 Determination

Acquisition may be put into effect

9 October 2026

1. Determination and statement of reasons

Notified acquisition	Bupa Health Services Pty Ltd (Bupa)’s proposed acquisition of 100% of the shares in Partnered Health Pty Ltd (Partnered Health) (the Acquisition).
Determination	The Australian Competition and Consumer Commission has determined under section 51ABZE(1) of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) that the Acquisition may be put into effect.
Parties to the Acquisition	Bupa provides a range of services in Australia. In addition to its operations in health insurance, primary care, aged care homes and retirement villages, Bupa: - operates general practitioner clinics and provides administrative, IT and other services to independent general practitioners (GPs) who supply their clinical services to patients as independent contractors, - operates dental clinics and provides administrative and other services to independent dentists, who supply their services to patients as independent contractors, - supplies psychology and mental health services under the ‘Mindplace’ brand, - supplies specific services to the Commonwealth Government in relation to visa medical checks and the health needs of the Australian Defence Force and veterans, and - supplies optical and hearing services under the ‘Bupa Optical’ brand. The target, Partnered Health, is a national provider of primary care services to individuals, and corporate health and wellbeing services to businesses and government customers. In primary care, Partnered Health operates medical centres offering GP and allied health services. Partnered Health also offers skin checks under the ‘Molescan’ brand, dietetics under the ‘Fuel Your Life’ brand, physiotherapy under the ‘Northcare Physio’ brand and psychology under the ‘New View Psychology’ and ‘NewPsych Psychologists’ brands. In occupational health and wellbeing, Partnered Health offers corporate health services under the ‘JobFit’ and ‘Baseline Onsite’ brands.
Overlap and relationship between the Parties	Bupa and Partnered Health overlap in: - the supply of facilities and services to GPs and, effectively, the supply of GP services to patients, - the supply of psychology services, and - the supply of a broad category of occupational health services to business and government employers (occupational health services comprise a range of services to support employee physical and mental wellbeing, including pre-employment and periodic medical assessments workers’ compensation services, injury prevention services, on-site services and employee assistance programs).

	Bupa and Partnered Health also have a minor vertical relationship, whereby Bupa acquires services from Partnered Health as part of Bupa's provision of immigration visa medical services to the Department of Home Affairs and health services to Australian Defence Force personnel.
Reasons for determination	When making a determination in Phase 1, the Australian Competition and Consumer Commission (ACCC) undertakes a competition assessment and considers whether it is appropriate for an acquisition to be approved or subject to further assessment in Phase 2 in accordance with section 51ABZJ of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) (the Act). In doing so, the ACCC must have regard to the object of the Act and all relevant matters, including the interests of consumers. For more information about the ACCC's approach to considering notified acquisitions, see the ACCC's merger assessment guidelines and interim merger process guidelines. In conducting its competition assessment, the ACCC has considered the information and documents that were submitted with the notification form, publicly available information and information from third parties. The ACCC has determined that the Acquisition may be put into effect as it considers that the Acquisition would be unlikely to have the effect of substantially lessening competition in any market. In reaching its decision, and based on the material before it, the ACCC makes the following findings. • In each local area where both parties supply facilities and services to GPs and their patients, the market share aggregation resulting from the Acquisition is low and there are effective alternatives available. • In each local area where both parties provide psychology services, the market share aggregation resulting from the Acquisition is low and there are effective alternatives available. • In respect of the supply of occupational health services to employers, the parties are not close competitors and the merged firm would continue to face competition from alternative suppliers.
Applications for review	A notifying party, or other person who has been allowed to do so by the Australian Competition Tribunal, may apply for review if they are dissatisfied with the determination. Pursuant to section 100C of the Act, applications for review of the determination are to be made to the Australian Competition Tribunal before the end of 14 calendar days after this statement of reasons was included on the ACCC's Acquisitions Register. To confirm whether there has been any application for review, please contact the Australian Competition Tribunal.

Determination made by Commissioner Williams pursuant to a delegation under section 25(1) of the Act